

Feel - Balanced sound profile great for wide genre of music including Metal, Rock, Jazz and the likes.

Immerse - The holy grail for Bass-heads! Immerse mode drowns your senses and is recommended when you wish to go crazy and satisfy your bass crave especially for Electronic music, Hip-hop, Rap and the likes.

Beast - Tune into beast mode to live the explosions, rumble and gunshots that otherwise is not reproduced by headphones. The powerful subwoofer emulation lets you feast on an ultimate cinematic and gaming experience.

That's about it in this department. Features like ANC, talk-through mode and the rest of the shebang have been left out in favour of redirected development costs put towards better tuning and development of the proprietary subwoofer on these headphones. Now, let's have a look at the performance.

PERFORMANCE

Whatever ground the Sonic Lamb Headphones lost in terms of features and build, they make that up in the performance department. The readings in the sub-bass region were almost absent, while the rest of it is pretty balanced until you get to the high-mids, which have been boosted. Why is it? Well, these headphones employ a new way of producing sub-bass. They do it using a combination of the Hear and Impulse drivers. The Hear driver is what produces the frequencies above the mid-bass region, and the Impulse driver is responsible for the sub-bass, which you feel as the rumble in action scenes and bass-heavy tracks. Instead of a membrane, like traditional drivers, the Impulse driver, which the makers of these headphones have developed, sends out a series of mechanically generated pulses, which are transmitted to you via the ear pads, hence the name Wooferpads.

This is a really interesting development and implementation of audio reproduction, unlike what we have seen so far. This is also what allows for the controlling of the different levels of bass reproduction on these headphones. While the highest level, which is the Beast mode can be a bit

overwhelming for many, the Hear and the Feel modes are what I believe will see the most use amongst the people who buy these headphones.

Now, coming to the experience of using these headphones. In tracks where there is a distinct bass line, like Uptown Funk, you get an excellent representation of the instrument, and the bass does not overshadow the rest of the frequencies. And, given that we at the Test Centre compare every headphone's response to the flat response of Pink Noise, these headphones stand tall in my rankings. The boost in the highs can introduce sibilance, which is the distinct and sharp representation of "S" and "T" sounds, which can cause discomfort to some people. However, when I used these headphones, it was not an issue. In vocal-heavy tracks as well, like Rescue Me by One Republic, the representation of every instrument, along with Ryan Tedder's voice, was on point. And, given the bass customisation, these headphones pretty much cover all the demographics that will be using these headphones. Now, that is what we can call a well-rounded product.

However, it is not all there is. When I was gaming on these headphones or listening to tracks that had densely packed instruments in them, sometimes I experienced a separation of the sub-bass from the rest of the frequencies, which was slightly off-putting. This was especially true when I was using the Immerse mode. Now, this is not something that is a plaguing issue on most tracks, and I found it difficult to reproduce myself. So, keep that in mind, but I would say it shouldn't be a deterrent to getting these headphones for the most part. They are still in their first iteration of commercial production and they will improve over time, I believe.

As for the mic, in-games, my team mates were able to hear me clearly, and there was minimal noise picked up by the headphones. And, wired connectivity meant that there was no noticeable lag in the audio as well. Another box ticked off by these headphones. There is no ANC, but the passive isolation on these headphones is great. You will not want to carry these on a flight as such, but for regular use at home, it should do the job.

BATTERY LIFE

Given that there is no ANC on the Sonic Lamb headphones, they can last up to 24 hours when you have the Hear mode toggled on. In my testing, these headphones gave me 22.5 hours of listening time, which is pretty close to the claimed numbers. As you increase the intensity of the bass, the listening time reduces, with the Beast mode giving a claimed battery of only 6 hours. So, you will want to use that sparingly. They charge via USB-C, and the makers claim that they go from 0 to a 100 per cent battery in two hours. This is something I would like to work on in future iterations, with the introduction of quick charge technology.

VERDICT

Sonic Lamb Headphones have a very distinct position in the market. They bring a sound signature that would appeal to the purists but lack on the features that are in demand by the masses. The only pair of headphones I would compare them to, are the ATH-BT line of headphones by Audio-Technica, which I reviewed earlier in the year – Audio Technica ATH-M50xBT2 and the Audio-Technica ATH-M20xBT. Both these headphones, too face a similar dilemma. I will make it simple for you.

If you are someone who is a fan of a flat-sounding pair of headphones but would also love to use them for content consumption and gaming on the go, I will say go for the Sonic Lamb Headphones over the Audio Technica offerings. However, if you are someone who works with audio professionally, and is looking for a pair that you can wear outside the studio, then I would recommend the Audio Technica headphones.

–Satvik Pandey

SPECIFICATIONS

Drivers: 2 x 40mm Dynamic + 2 x 27mm Impulse | Processor: Qualcomm QCC3034 | Audio codec: Bluetooth 5.1 Apt-X Adaptive | Frequency Response: 5Hz - 24kHz | Battery: 1400mAh | Battery life: 24hrs (Hear mode) 6hrs (Beast mode) 140hrs (standby) | Weight: 320g

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